

tions, and enhancements in the iCloud feature.

So did the hugely successful iOS really need an update at this point? Well, maybe it did. With Android close on its heels Apple is under constant pressure to perform, innovate and differentiate. Nokia, who joined the smartphone bandwagon late and remained in a fairly dormant state with its Symbian environment gained a new lease on life with its Lumia series. While in no immediate danger of losing its market share or set of loyalists, Apple needed some fresh changes to keep up with the massively dynamic industry. Just maybe Apple's largely constant user interface needed an overhaul.



The new flat look

A failure in the form of Apple's maps utility on the iOS 6 led to the exit of iOS Design head Scott Forstall, bringing Apple's successful industrial design wizard Jony Ive to the forefront. Ive's was not a fan of Apple's ornamental design philosophy and Skeumorphic elements. It was considered as distracting and in conflict with the simplistic general tone of the design. So naturally when he was declared as the head of the design team analysts predicted that Apple will make a few design changes. It turned out that the iOS 7 was the biggest change in the history of Apple's software releases.

Visually, iOS 7 is quite an overhaul and is easily the most crisp, flat and minimalistic UI that Apple has come up with. With iOS 7, Apple has finally said goodbye to Skeumorphism that lent features like faux wood and felt on backgrounds and ruled lines for notepads etc. The new design also drifted away from the classic shading, gradients and shine that one would associate with previous version of the OS. Shadow effect too is no more present. Though this version is more flat it relies on layering and introduces a